

FOST TRAINING RULE OF THE ROAD TEST JAN 16

This test is based on: The International Regulations for Preventing Collisions at Sea (1972) with amendments in force up to December 2009 as detailed in "A Seaman's Guide Pocket Book of The International Regulations for Preventing Collisions at Sea" (BR 453 Supp), ATP1(F) Vol I and the Mariners Handbook (NP100).

The test is designed to be given to any Warfare Officer, Deck officer, Officer undertaking bridge watch-keeping duties or Young Officer/Cadet. The test should be administered under written exam conditions, the results should be recorded in the OOW training records for inspection by FOST navigation staff. The exam should take no longer than 1 hr.

In this test, any change in the status of the ship or of the environment will be indicated in the script. Rules 1 to 19, 34, 35 and Annex IV must be known instinctively for instant application. A thorough knowledge of the other rules is required. The pass mark is 90% (54 out of 60)

You are the SSD Officer of the Watch of a T23 frigate (length 133m). The ship has just completed a mid-deployment port visit to Sydney, Australia. The forecast is for fair weather after morning fog, although showers are possible. Your ship sails at 0900 and after stern boarding into the main channel the CO steadies up on course. It is the forenoon watch the weather is fine, good visibility and moderate shipping.

1. With a large variety of vessels present the CO asks the new joined BFT YO to define the term "vessel". What would your answer be? **(3a)** (2)

2. The NO follows this up by asking what is meant by the term "vessel constrained by her draught"? **(3h)** (2)

3. You are heading towards a bend in the channel, the approaches of which are obscured. What sound signal do you make? **(34e)**

4. What should any vessel hearing your signal do? **(34e)** (1)

5. You turn at rest in the main channel and proceed outbound at a safe speed in accordance with Harbour Regulations. How do the Rules define safe speed? **(6)** (2)

6. What are the six factors to be taken into account by all ships in determining safe speed **(6a)**
(6)
7. As you proceed along the planned navtrack you sight a power-driven vessel right ahead on or nearly on a reciprocal course such that a risk of collision exists, what action should you take? **(14a)**
(1)
8. What three basic criteria do the Rules stipulate for action taken to avoid collision, if the circumstances of the case admit? **(8a)**
(3)
9. Additionally, what is required of any alterations of course and/or speed to avoid collision, if the circumstances of the case admit? **(8b)**
(2)
10. Still in the channel, a rather impatient ferry astern sounds two prolonged blasts followed by one short blast. What does this indicate? **(34c(i))**
(1)
11. When shall a vessel be deemed to be overtaking? **(13)**
(2)
12. To exit Port Jackson (Sydney Harbour) you have to pass through a traffic separation scheme (TSS).
- a. What vessels shall avoid impeding your passage when transiting the TSS? **(10(i)(j))**
(2)

- b. On what occasions, other than crossing a TSS, can vessels enter a Separation Zone? **(10e)** (2)

You are required to carry out a helicopter transfer to disembark the Pilot.

13. a. To what group of vessels are you assigned in the Rules, and why? **(3g(iv))** (1)
- b. What other vessels are included in this category? (5)

14. You clear the TSS and near the coast you sight a vessel displaying the following shapes:



- a. What is the vessel doing? **(27f)** (1)
- b. What distance must you not approach this vessel? **(27f)** (1)

After proceeding into open water, you sight a small merchant vessel at Red 45 range 4nm. Following a standard shipping report to the CO there is no appreciable change of bearing as the vessel closes.

15. a. What initial action is required of you? **(17a(i))** (1)
- b. What action may you take if it becomes apparent that the other vessel is not taking appropriate action in accordance with the Rules? **(17a(ii))** (1)
- c. What alteration should you avoid making? **(17c)** (1)

- d. What action shall you take if you find yourself so close that collision cannot be avoided by the action of the other vessel alone? **(17b)** (1)

The small merchant vessel alters course at 1.5nm and passes clear. Soon after a torrential rainstorm overtakes the ship and visibility is reduced to 200 yards.

16. You detect on several contacts by radar and ascertain, by plotting, that a risk of collision is developing. You decide to avoid collision by altering course. What alterations should you avoid making as laid down in the Rules? **(19d)** (2)

17. List three of the six additional considerations that shall be among those taken into account when determining a safe speed with operational radar? **(6b)** (3)

18. What sound signal should you make and at what intervals? **(35a)** (1)

Eventually the rain squall clears and the passage continues in good visibility.

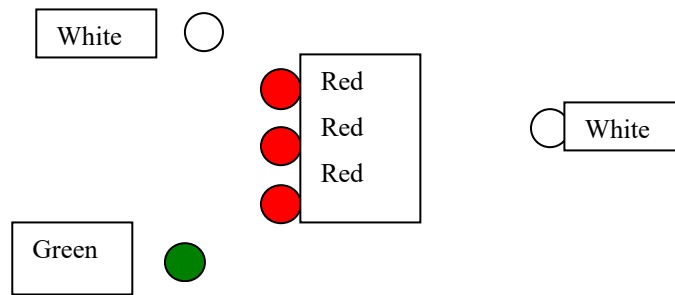
19. You encounter a line of patrol boats crossing your port bow, en route to Sydney. As the senior ship the CO decides he wants to pass through the column for a closer inspection. What action is required of you prior to and whilst passing through the line? **(ATP 1(F) Article 2243(d))** (2)

20. If one of the vessels in the line had a breakdown, what primary action and standard signals would be expected from the disable vessel? **(ATP 1(F) Article 2260(b))** (2)

You clear the Patrol Boats and continue to passage north.

21. You sight a vessel engaged in fishing and your 2OOW asks what vessels, so far as possible, should a vessel engaged in fishing keep out of the way of. What answer do you give him? **18(c)** (2)

You go off watch and come back on after sunset and observe the following lights.



22. What do you determine about this vessel? **(23(a) & 28)** (2)

23. You sight a vessel displaying two all-round lights in a vertical line, the upper being red and the lower white, in addition to sidelights and stern light. What is this? **(26c)** (2)

24. The quartermaster asks how you would know if the vessel was in distress. What are six distress signals that can be used by vessels in distress? **(Annex IV)** (6)

ANSWERS

You are the SSD Officer of the Watch of a T23 frigate (length 133m). The ship has just completed a mid-deployment port visit to Sydney, Australia. The forecast is for fair weather after morning fog, although showers are possible. Your ship sails at 0900 and after stern boarding into the main channel the CO steadies up on course. It is the forenoon watch the weather is fine, good visibility and moderate shipping.

1. With a large variety of vessels present the CO asks the new joined BFT YO to define the term "vessel". What would your answer be? **(3a)** (2)

The word "vessel" includes every description of water craft, including non-displacement craft, WIG craft and seaplanes, used or capable of being used as a means of transportation on water.

2. The NO follows this up by asking what is meant by the term "vessel constrained by her draught"? **(3h)** (2)

The term "vessel constrained by her draught" means a power driven vessel which, because of her draught in relation to the available depth and width of navigable water, is severely restricted in her ability to deviate from the course she is following.

3. You are heading towards a bend in the channel, the approaches of which are obscured. What sound signal do you make? **(34e)**

A vessel nearing a bend or an area of a channel or fairway where the other vessel may be obscured by an intervening obstruction shall sound one prolonged blast. (1)

4. What should any vessel hearing your signal do? **(34e)**

Such signal shall be answered with a prolonged blast by any vessel that may be within hearing around the bend or behind the obstruction. (1)

5. You turn at rest in the main channel and proceed outbound at a safe speed in accordance with Harbour Regulations. How do the Rules define safe speed? **(6)** (2)

Every vessel shall at all times proceed at a safe speed so that she can take proper and effective action to avoid collision and be stopped within a distance appropriate to the prevailing circumstances and conditions.

6. What are the six factors to be taken into account by all ships in determining safe speed **(6a)** (6)

- (i) the state of visibility;***
- (ii) the traffic density including concentrations of fishing vessels or any other vessels;***
- (iii) the manoeuvrability of the vessel with special reference to stopping distance and turning ability in the prevailing conditions;***
- (iv) at night the presence of background light such as from shore lights or from the backscatter of her own lights;***
- (v) the state of wind, sea and current, and the proximity of navigational hazards;***
- (vi) the draught in relation to the available depth of water.***

7. As you proceed along the planned navtrack you sight a power-driven vessel right ahead on or nearly on a reciprocal course such that a risk of collision exists, what action should you take? **(14a)** (1)

When two power-driven vessels are meeting on reciprocal or nearly reciprocal courses so as to involve risk of collision each shall alter course to starboard so that each vessel shall pass on the port side of each other.

8. What three basic criteria do the Rules stipulate for action taken to avoid collision, if the circumstances of the case admit? **(8a)** (3)

Any action to avoid collision shall be taken in accordance with the Rules of this Part and shall, if the circumstances of the case admit, be positive, made in ample time and with due regard to the observance of good seamanship.

9. Additionally, what is required of any alterations of course and/or speed to avoid collision, if the circumstances of the case admit? **(8b)** (2)

Any alteration of course and/or speed to avoid collision shall, if the circumstances of the case admit, be large enough to be readily apparent to another vessel observing visually or by radar; a succession of small alterations of course and/or speed should be avoided.

10. Still in the channel, a rather impatient ferry astern sounds two prolonged blasts followed by one short blast. What does this indicate? **(34c(i))** (1)

"I intend to overtake you on your starboard side"

11. When shall a vessel be deemed to be overtaking? **(13)** (2)

A vessel shall be deemed to be overtaking when coming up with another vessel from a direction more than 22.5° abaft her beam, that is, in such a position with reference to the vessel she is overtaking, that at night she would be able to see only the sternlight of that vessel but neither of her side lights.

12. To exit Port Jackson (Sydney Harbour) you have to pass through a traffic separation scheme (TSS).

a. What vessels shall avoid impeding your passage when transiting the TSS? **(10(i)(j))** (2)

(i) A vessel engaged in fishing **shall not impede the passage of any vessel following a traffic lane.**

(j) ***A vessel of less than 20m in length or a sailing vessel shall not impede the safe passage of a power-driven vessel following a traffic lane.***

b. On what occasions, other than crossing a TSS, can vessels enter a Separation Zone? **(10e)** (2)

(i) ***in cases of emergency to avoid immediate danger;***

(ii) ***to engage in fishing within a separation zone.***

You are required to carry out a helicopter transfer to disembark the Pilot.

13. a. To what group of vessels are you assigned in the Rules, and why? **(3g(iv))** (1)

Vessels restricted in their ability to manoeuvre. A vessel engaged in the launching or recovery of aircraft.

c. What other vessels are included in this category? (5)

(i) **a vessel engaged in laying, servicing or picking up a navigation mark, submarine cable or pipeline;**

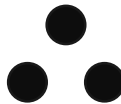
(ii) **a vessel engaged in dredging, surveying or underwater operations;**

(iii) **a vessel engaged in replenishment or transferring persons or cargo while underway;**

(v) **a vessel engaged in mine clearance operations;**

(vi) **a vessel engaged in a towing operation such as severely restricts the towing vessel and her tow in their ability to deviate from their course.**

14. You clear the TSS and near the coast you sight a vessel displaying the following shapes:



a. What is the vessel doing? (27f) (1)

Mine clearance operations

b. What distance must you not approach this vessel? (27f) (1)

These shapes indicate it is dangerous for another vessel to approach within 1000m of the mine clearance vessel

After proceeding into open water, you sight a small merchant vessel at Red 45 range 4nm. Following a standard shipping report to the CO there is no appreciable change of bearing as the vessel closes.

15. a. What initial action is required of you? (17a(i)) (1)

Where one of two vessels is to keep out of the way the other shall keep her course and speed.

b. What action may you take if it becomes apparent that the other vessel is not taking appropriate action in accordance with the Rules? (17a(ii)) (1)

The latter vessel may, however, take action to avoid collision by her manoeuvre alone, as soon as it becomes apparent to her that the vessel required to keep out of the way is not taking appropriate action in compliance with these Rules.

c. What alteration should you avoid making? (17c) (1)

A power-driven vessel which takes action in a crossing situation in accordance with subparagraph (a) (ii) of this Rule to avoid collision with another power-driven vessel shall, if the circumstances of the case admit, not alter course to port for a vessel on her own port side.

d. What action shall you take if you find yourself so close that collision cannot be avoided by the action of the other vessel alone? (17b) (1)

When, from any cause, the vessel required to keep her course and speed finds herself so close that collision cannot be avoided by the action of the give-way vessel alone, she shall take such action as will best aid to avoid collision.

The small merchant vessel alters course at 1.5nm and passes clear. Soon after a torrential rainstorm overtakes the ship and visibility is reduced to 200 yards.

16. You detect on several contacts by radar and ascertain, by plotting, that a risk of collision is developing. You decide to avoid collision by altering course. What alterations should you avoid making as laid down in the Rules? **(19d)** (2)

(i) an alteration of course to port for a vessel forward of the beam, other than for a vessel being overtaken;

(ii) an alteration of course towards a vessel abeam or abaft the beam.

17. List three of the six additional considerations that shall be among those taken into account when determining a safe speed with operational radar? **(6b)** (3)

(i) the characteristics, efficiency and limitations of the radar equipment;

(ii) any constraints imposed by the radar range scale in use;

(iii) the effect on radar detection of the sea state, weather and other sources of interference;

(iv) the possibility that small vessels, ice and other floating objects may not be detected by radar at an adequate range;

(v) the number, location and movement of vessels detected by radar;

(vi) the more exact assessment of the visibility that may be possible when radar is used to determine the range of vessels or other objects in the vicinity.

18. What sound signal should you make and at what intervals? **(35a)** (1)

A power-driven vessel making way through the water shall sound at intervals of not more than 2 minutes one prolonged blast.

Eventually the rain squall clears and the passage continues in good visibility.

19. You encounter a line of patrol boats crossing your port bow, en route to Sydney. As the senior ship the CO decides he wants to pass through the column for a closer inspection. What action is required of you prior to and whilst passing through the line? **(ATP 1(F) Article 2243(d))** (2)

The senior officer must indicate his intention to pass through the ships in the line and avoid hampering the other ships.

20. If one of the vessels in the line had a breakdown, what primary action and standard signals would be expected from the disabled vessel? **(ATP 1(F) Article 2260(b))** (2)

Sound at least six short blasts, hoist flag 5 and 2 black balls (NUC) or 2 red all round lights, indicate if turning to port or starboard with appropriate sound signal and inform the OTC

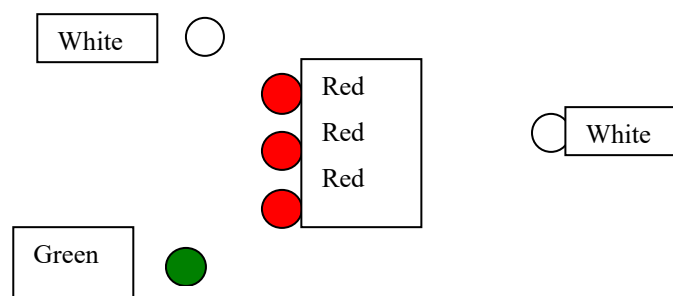
You clear the Patrol Boats and continue to passage north.

21. You sight a vessel engaged in fishing and your 200W asks what vessels, so far as possible, should a vessel engaged in fishing keep out of the way of. What answer do you give him? **18(c)** (2)

A vessel engaged in fishing when underway shall, so far as possible, keep out of the way of:

- (i) a vessel not under command;**
- (ii) a vessel restricted in her ability to manoeuvre**

You go off watch and come back on after sunset and observe the following lights.



22. What do you determine about this vessel? **(23(a) & 28)** (2)

- a. Vessel constrained by her draught**
- b. Over 50m**
- c. Underway**
- d. Starboard bow aspect**

23. You sight a vessel displaying two all-round lights in a vertical line, the upper being red and the lower white, in addition to sidelights and stern light. What is this? **(26c)** (2)

A vessel engaged in fishing, other than trawling, when making way through the water.

23. The quartermaster asks how you would know if the vessel was in distress. What are six distress signals that can be used by vessels in distress? **(Annex IV)** (6)

6 from Annex IV